



One content platform on GCP

A decision framework for replacing 27 Drupal sites with one governed content platform

DECISION PROPOSAL

Approve a focused Payload POC

Decision	Proposal
Direction	Evaluate Payload as the preferred replacement for 27 Drupal instances
Commitment now	One team for six weeks, with up to two additional weeks for unresolved gaps; a technical meeting with Payload sales and a solutions engineer
POC evidence	ONE’s use cases, Drupal news/iframe imports, safe operation and OTS SLA compliance
Decision afterwards	Approve implementation after gate review, with Enterprise scope and CMS costs documented

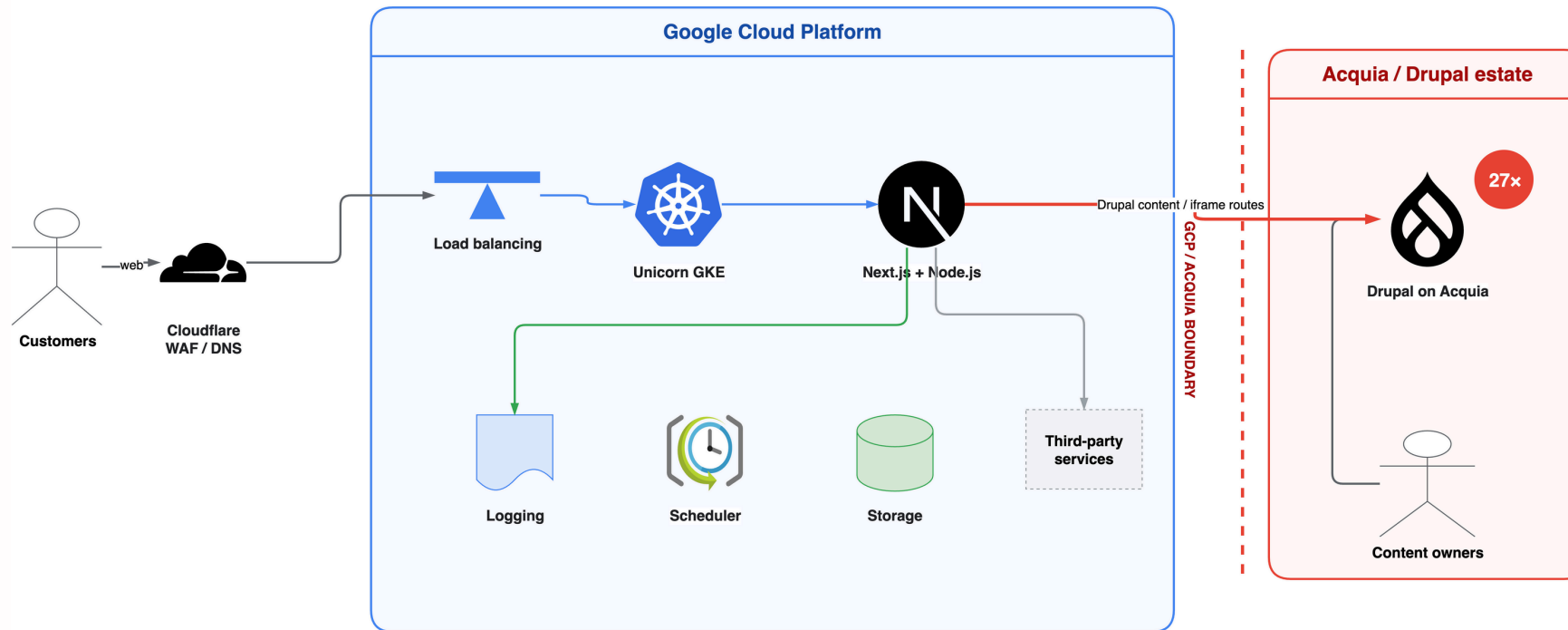
Expected outcome: lower CMS running cost and maintenance effort, with more consistent publishing.

The provisional 18-month implementation target starts after the POC and implementation approval.

Current delivery already combines Next.js and Drupal

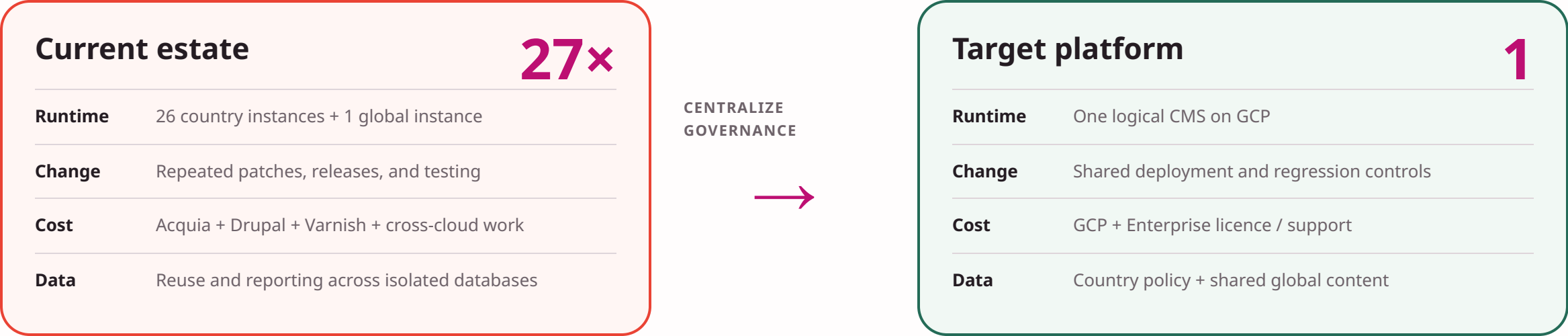
Current platform context: Next.js composes GCP and Drupal delivery

CMS delivery only: native Next.js routes and legacy Drupal / iframe routes cross the GCP / Acquia boundary directly.



Mixed delivery exists today; migration can move route ownership gradually instead of waiting for one big cutover.

Replace 27 separate CMS stacks with one governed platform



The business case comes from retiring repeated platform work across 27 stacks.

Improve publishing without weakening engineering control

01

Platform ownership

GCP, PostgreSQL, GCS, backup, and restore.

02

Global publishing

26 country sites, one global site, seven languages, and scoped access.

03

Editorial control

Preview, review, approval, scheduling, and translation state.

04

Structured experience

Approved blocks and rich text, not arbitrary styling.

05

Digital operations

Forms, SEO, audit, observability, and environment promotion.

06

Controlled transition

Drupal coexistence, Enterprise support and room for AI integration.

These six outcomes define the minimum acceptable platform.

Payload and Directus: the differences that matter

Shared starting point

Self-hosted content platforms with APIs, access controls and extensibility. ONE's tenant and workflow fit still needs validation.

Payload advantage

React and TypeScript alignment, official forms and multi-tenant plugins, code-first extensions, and an MIT-licensed core.

Directus advantage

Schema/configuration sync, Studio automation and Flows, broad data-platform flexibility, and existing internal familiarity.

Evidence still required

ONE's tenant model, Enterprise workflows, Drupal imports, operations, support and CMS costs.

Payload is the preferred candidate; Directus remains the comparison if the POC reveals a fundamental gap.

Payload fits the engineering model ONE already uses

Familiar stack

TypeScript, React, Next.js and PostgreSQL align with our application skills and AI-assisted development approach.

Extensible platform

Official plugins provide forms and multi-tenancy. Custom plugins can handle ONE-specific integrations and migration needs.

Shared operations

Reuse GKE and Cloudflare, own the database and media, and maintain one governed CMS platform.

The POC must prove use-case coverage and operational fit. Enterprise features require hands-on confirmation.

A shared publishing workflow for country and global teams

27

site scopes

26 country sites + 1 global site

7 supported languages

English

Chinese

Japanese

Korean

Spanish

Portuguese

French

Write

Create within approved blocks and fields

Preview

See the actual Next.js experience while editing

Review + translate

Visible status, feedback, and role-based transitions

Publish

Approve, schedule, and publish with accountability

Country defines ownership and access. Language is a separate publishing choice.

Room for governed AI integration

Writers + translators

AI translation with human review; writing and image tools remain subject to release confirmation.

Editors + content operations

Brand prompts, glossaries, structured-content checks, permissions, and reusable governance.

Developers

Approved tools can work with CMS schemas and content through permission-scoped MCP connections.

Payload Enterprise

AI translation, permissions, and MCP. The AI page marks image generation and writing assistance “Coming Soon”.

Directus Enterprise

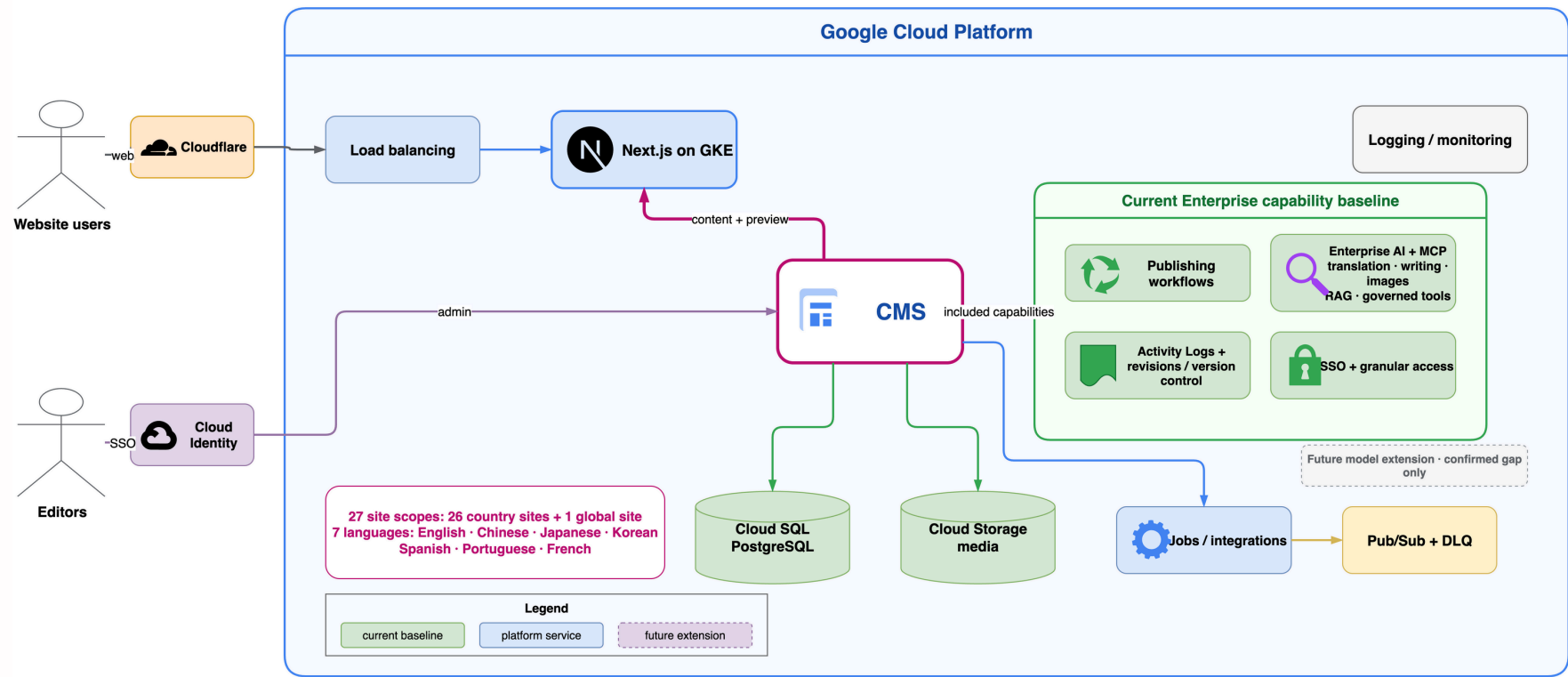
Studio Assistant, multi-language translation, custom models, and MCP for editors and developers.

Room for AI integration through plugins and MCP. AI costs will be calculated separately from the CMS budget.

Target architecture on the existing GCP platform

Target: one governed CMS with Enterprise capabilities on GCP

Enterprise AI, MCP, workflow, and audit serve 26 country sites plus one global site from one governed platform.



Country ownership and language choice remain independent.

Reuse the existing GKE cluster and Cloudflare project; add Cloud SQL and a dedicated GCS bucket.

The POC tests ONE’s operating model on Payload

Already understood from the demo and documentation	POC focus
Code-first CMS; TypeScript, Next.js and PostgreSQL fit	Actual global/country ownership, shared content and access rules
Official Multi-Tenant and Form Builder plugins	Real tenant isolation and a representative business form
Self-hosting on GCP / GKE is feasible	Recovery, performance and operations in ONE’s shared cluster
Official and custom plugin extension model	Import news and iframe pages from Drupal; explore environment promotion separately
Enterprise workflow and AI portfolio is advertised	PPO confirmation of required publishing and translation flows; assess available AI

Build on the demo. Prove the remaining risks with real Drupal data and PPO flow confirmation.

Six-week POC target with two-week contingency

Team A · POC

Developers pair across tenant/workflow, Drupal imports, and platform/integration work. QA validates continuously; PPO owns acceptance; TA owns architecture.

Team B · Existing delivery

Continues current delivery during the POC. Proposed implementation split: Team A owns the platform; Team B owns website integration and migration.

3 × two-week sprints with AI Agent support; up to 2 extra weeks only for unresolved validation or vendor dependencies.

PO provides higher-level direction and approvals outside the teams.

Three planned sprints, then contingency only if needed

Workstream	Sprint 1 · Weeks 1–2	Sprint 2 · Weeks 3–4	Sprint 3 · Weeks 5–6
Engineering + QA	Confirm tenant rules; profile Drupal samples; verify Enterprise access	Import news and iframe pages; rerun checks; publishing and form flows	Operational rehearsals; resolve defects; review gates and costs
PPO validation	Confirm use cases and expected outcomes	Confirm imports, translation and form flows	Confirm end-to-end flows and gate evidence
Sprint exit	Access matrix and sample agreed	Import evidence and PPO-confirmed flows	Week 6: go / no-go review

Optional · Weeks 7–8: resolve named validation or vendor gaps, recheck affected flows and close remaining gates. No additional scope.

Close the POC as soon as its gates are met. No real-user training during the POC.

POC gates for the implementation decision

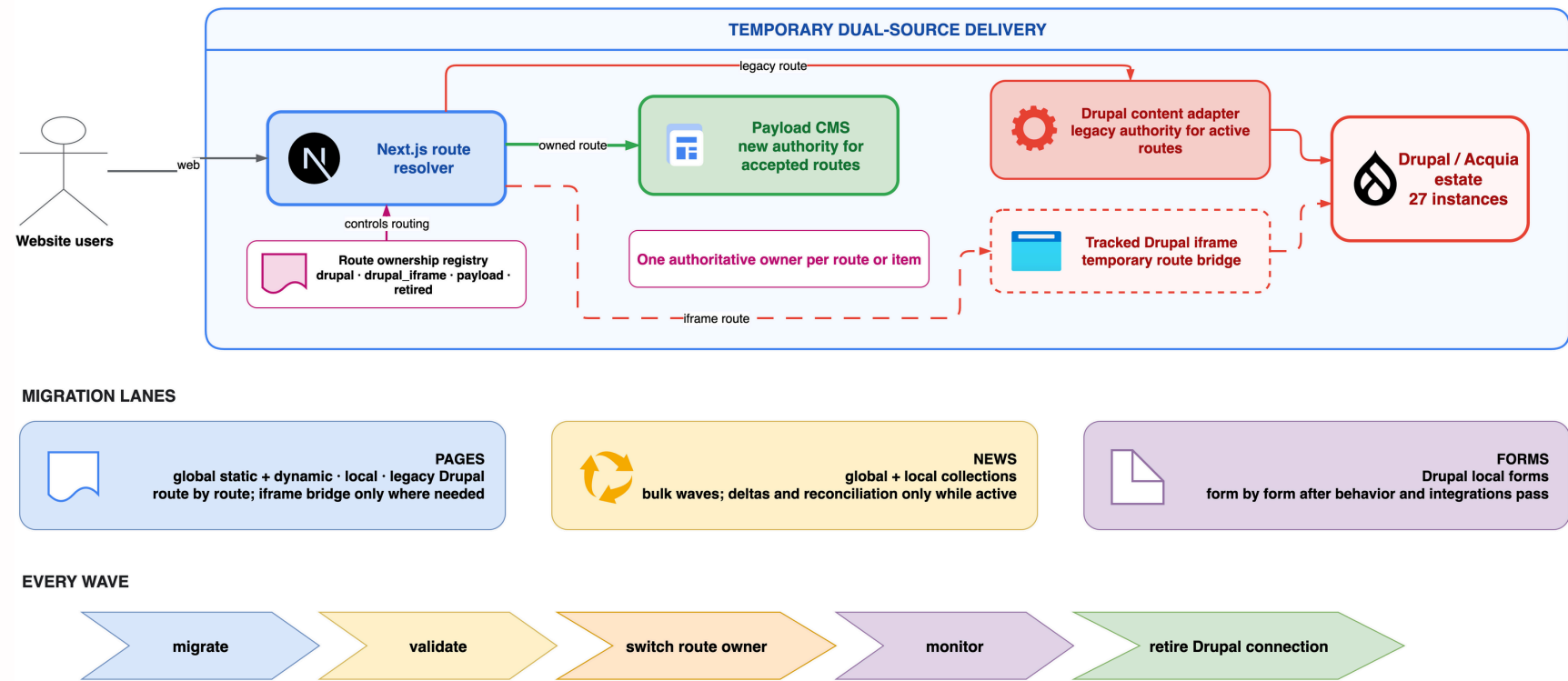
Gate	Evidence required
Use-case coverage	Payload covers ONE’s agreed tenant, publishing, translation and form use cases; PPO confirms the flows
Drupal import	Demonstrate the ability to import news and iframe pages from Drupal, including required media and relationships
Safe operation	Validate tenant access, approval controls and protection of unpublished content
Operations and recovery	Meet the OTS SLA
Quality and decision readiness	Zero open critical/high defects; PPO, TA and QA sign-off; Enterprise scope and CMS costs documented

Proceed when the gates are met. Unresolved required capabilities need an explicit scope, extension or no-go decision.

Migrate in waves while Next.js serves both CMSs

Coexistence: Next.js serves both CMSs while ownership moves in waves

Pages, news, and forms use the lightest safe migration method; each accepted wave retires its Drupal connection.



Frontend coexistence does not mean dual editing: rollback changes route ownership; it never reverse-syncs content.

One owner per route or item · route-level rollback · retire each Drupal connection after its wave is accepted

Every content group needs an owner and an accepted destination

Content group	Migration approach and business responsibility
All local and global pages	Migrate layouts, content, media and every required language; country/global owners approve
All news	Import from Drupal, preserve dates and relationships; reconcile final changes before cutover
Drupal iframe pages	Import underlying content and assets; rebuild required behavior; remove Drupal-hosted iframe dependencies
Forms	Business chooses migrate, rebuild or centralize per form; validate submissions, consent, routing and retention

During coexistence, new content goes to Payload as each destination becomes ready. Existing Drupal content migrates in waves.

An 18-month implementation target after the POC

Separate POC: 6 weeks + up to 2 optional weeks → acceptance and approval → implementation month 1

Phase	Engineering	Content creators + business
Months 1–3 · Foundation	Platform foundation and integrations	Content inventory, cleanup and form decisions
Months 4–6 · Pilot	Pilot launch; begin coexistence	Train pilot editors; user acceptance
Months 7–12 · Migration	Main page and news migration waves	Review languages; approve each wave
Months 13–15 · Remaining scope	Remaining iframe content and forms	Accept remaining content and forms
Months 16–18 · Retirement	Final migration deltas; retire Drupal	Final content sign-off and archive approval

Provisional: confirm team allocation, content-review capacity and form decisions after the POC. About 19.5–20 months including the separate POC, if consecutive.

CMS budget: shared infrastructure and Enterprise licence

Monthly cost · USD, rough planning allowance	Current Drupal / Acquia	New CMS increment
Hosting / compute	Pending Monday cost breakdown	Existing GKE cluster: \$0–200 added capacity
Database	Pending	Cloud SQL PostgreSQL HA, 2 vCPU / 8 GiB, 100 GiB SSD: \$300–500
Assets	Pending	New GCS bucket, assumed 100 GiB: \$5–20 storage / operations
Edge, telemetry, backup and network allowance	Pending	Existing Cloudflare project + usage allowance: \$50–150
Shared DEV / STAGE allowance	Pending	\$100–250
Infrastructure subtotal	TBD · Monday input	About \$500–1,150 / month · \$6,000–13,800 / year
CMS licence / support	Included scope to confirm	Payload Enterprise: TBC

CMS budget = added infrastructure + Enterprise licence (TBC). AI and development costs are excluded.

Drupal costs continue during coexistence. Savings start as its services and contracts retire.

Platform success: complete migration and practical improvements

Measure	Proposed platform target
Drupal retirement	100% of agreed Drupal content migrated and accepted across all 27 site scopes; no Drupal dependencies by implementation month 18
Editor readiness	At least 80% of active editors trained and able to complete core publishing tasks
Publishing efficiency	Aim for 10% less publishing and reviewed translation time, without reducing content quality
Service reliability	At least 99% annual CMS availability; operations and recovery meet the OTS SLA
Cost and maintenance	Lower CMS running cost and maintenance effort than the current Drupal estate

Confirm improvement targets against the Drupal baseline during implementation; review results after each rollout wave.

Reliable service with clear technical measures

Area	Target or review criterion	Measurement
Availability	At least 99% annual CMS and public-delivery availability	Measure each service annually, including planned downtime
Security	No open critical/high findings; tenant and draft access controls verified	Security scans and access tests before release
Speed	Public delivery and editor actions perform at least as well as the agreed baseline	Response times and errors under representative load
Content freshness	Approved content appears correctly on the site and in search	Publish-to-visible checks
Operations and recovery	Meet the OTS SLA	Confirm SLA compliance

Set detailed performance targets during implementation using actual traffic, content volume and platform capacity.

A technical discovery meeting with Payload sales

Agenda with sales + solutions engineer

Enterprise pricing and terms; feature depth and availability; ONE’s technical and workflow questions.

Tenant isolation, Drupal import, environment sync, GKE operations, security, recovery and AI data handling.

Expected outputs

Written answers and actions, Enterprise scope, technical constraints and trial access.

CMS licence/support quote or due date and a cost comparison against the 27 Drupal instances. Any AI pricing is separate.

Requested approval: engage Payload sales and allocate Team A to the POC once access and prerequisites are ready.

Next decision: review the POC evidence and confirm the implementation scope, capacity and budget.



Thank you for listening

Questions and discussion